



Studying in a University:

21st Century Literacies



GNS 101: USE OF ENGLISH I:

☐ **Method of Teaching:**

☐ The Blended Learning approach will be employed in teaching the course. This is an approach that combines face-to-face and online learning experience. The MOODLE (Modular Object-Oriented Dynamic Learning Environment) will be used as a learning platform for the course. This online learning management system involves the use of sequential series of web pages, discussion forums among students and teachers, e-mails and directories (for uploading and sharing files).

☐ **Course Organisation**

☐ The course consists of two hours of Face-to-Face teaching and learning per week; this arrangement affords students the opportunity to learn in the physical class. Learning also takes place outside class, in the students' groups and in virtual space. Students are expected to do their assigned readings before coming to class and their other assignments. The course is interactive therefore active participation is important alongside regular class attendance.

DIFFERENT MODES OF LEARNING



LANGUAGE SKILLS

Four language skills:

- ▮ Listening
- ▮ Speaking
- ▮ Reading
- ▮ Writing

The four skills are related to each other by two parameters:

- ▮ the mode of communication: oral or written
- ▮ the direction of communication: receiving or producing the message

RECEPTIVE SKILLS

- ❑ The receptive skills are
 - ❑ LISTENING
 - ❑ READING
- ❑ Learners do not need to produce language to do these: they receive and understand it.
- ❑ They can be contrasted with the **productive** of speaking and writing.
- ❑ These skills are sometimes erroneously described as passive skills, as if they require no activity.
- ❑ Note that all skills require some activity.



PRODUCTIVE SKILLS

☒ The productive skills are

☒ SPEAKING

☒ WRITING

☒ Learners doing these need to produce language.

☒ These skills are contrasted with the receptive skills of listening and reading.



21ST CENTURY LITERACY INVOLVE?

Basic literacy

Numeracy

Digital/e-literacy

Critical literacy

LITERACY

- ❖ Literacy is the ability to make and communicate meaning from and by the use of a variety of socially contextual symbols.
- ❖ Within various levels of developmental ability, a literate person can derive and convey meaning, and use their knowledge to achieve a desired purpose or goal that requires the use of language skills, be they spoken or written.

LITERACY

Literacy is "not in isolated bits of knowledge but in students' growing ability to use language and literacy in more and broader activities" (Moll, 1994).

The definition of literacy is dynamic, evolving, and reflects the continual changes in our society.

Literacy has, for instance, expanded to include literacy in information and communication technologies and critical literacy (Cunningham, 2000).

NUMERACY

- ⌘ Numeracy involve using mathematical ideas efficiently to make sense of the world.
- ⌘ While it necessarily involves understanding some mathematical ideas, notations and techniques, it also involves drawing on knowledge of particular contexts and circumstances in deciding when to use mathematics, choosing the mathematics to use and critically evaluating its use.

NUMERACY

- ⌘ A numerate person should understand some of the ways mathematics can be used for communication, and this required the possession of two attributes:
 - › Being 'at-ease' with all those aspects of mathematics that enable a person to cope with the practical demands of everyday life
 - › Being able to understand information presented in mathematical terms

DIGITAL LITERACY/E-LITERACY

- ❖ The ability to use digital technology, communication tools or networks to locate, evaluate, use and create information.
- ❖ The ability to understand and use information in multiple formats from a wide range of sources when it is presented via computers.
- ❖ The ability to read and interpret media, to reproduce data and images through digital manipulation, and to evaluate and apply new knowledge gained from digital environments

DESIRABLE DIGITAL LITERACY SKILLS

- ☐ Creation/management of digital identities
- ☐ Netiquette
- ☐ Using emails in an academic environment
- ☐ Using online resources
- ☐ Identification and evaluation of digital resources
- ☐ Downloading, saving and sharing files
- ☐ Uploading assignments

WHAT DOES “CRITICAL LITERACY” MEAN?

- ❖ The ability to read texts in an active, reflective, and questioning manner in order to better understand power, inequality and injustice in human relations (www.learnnc.org)
- ❖ The practice of challenging texts through an analysis of the roles that power, culture, class and gender play in the message of the texts.
- ❖ While reading a text critically, a reader assumes four roles
 - ❖ Code breaker: understanding the text at the surface level
 - ❖ Meaning maker: comprehending the text at the level intended by the author
 - ❖ Text user: analysing the factors that influenced the author and the text; and
 - ❖ Text critic: understanding that the text is not neutral, and

WHY DO WE NEED CRITICAL LITERACY SKILLS?

- ❖ All observation and description takes place within an already constructed framework of socially, ideologically and linguistically constructed reality, whether the observer/describer is articulately aware of that framework or not. (Burton 1982:196).
- ❖ Readers need to be aware of these informing ideologies in constructed texts.

NETIQUETTE

- ❖ The internet is the display of data in various formats on a monitor transmitted through cables and radio frequencies. Internet etiquette or netiquette is the social code of the internet, the set of practices created over the years to make the *Internet* experience pleasant for everyone.
- ❖ Like other forms of etiquette, netiquette is primarily concerned with matters of courtesy in communications on social media, whether it be by email, on forums, group chats or other social media interactions.
- ❖ The following sections provide more information on using emails.

USING EMAILS

❖ *Netiquette Basics*

- Help the newbies
- Research before asking
- Remember emotion

❖ **Netiquette of Sending Emails**

- ☒ Be brief
- ☒ Use white space
- ☒ Use descriptive subject lines
- ☒ Stay on-topic
- ☒ Be careful sending attachments

❖ **Netiquette of Replying Emails**

- ☒ Summarize for the group
- ☒ Check current information before replying
- ☒ Reference past communications
- ☒ Acknowledge important communications

RULES FOR USING E-PLATFORMS

UNIVERSITY LEARNING SITE, TELEGRAM & WHATSAPP

☒ ***General Information***

- ☒ Online platforms are extensions of our classrooms.
- ☒ We maintain roles of teachers, students and classmates.

☒ ***Available Learning Spaces***

- ☒ University virtual learning platform:
<http://elearning.futa.edu.ng/learning/>
- ☒ Telegram
- ☒ WhatsApp

UNIVERSITY LEARNING SITE

4 Forum platforms on the learning site:

- 1. Teachers' Forum (available to lecturers only);
- 2. News Forum (also only available to lecturers to give general information to all, but students have 'read-only' access);
- 3. General Forum (available to students to post and to discuss); and
- 4. Individual Lecturer's Forum (also available to students to post and to discuss).

GENERAL ACCESS FORUMS

- ☒ All students regardless of their School or Department have equal access to two forums:
- ☒ **News Forum:** Lecturers make announcements about the course, important discussions, tests, assignments and general processes of the course. Please read these discussions carefully and follow instructions.
- ☒ **General Forum:** For students to raise issues, discuss important points of interest about study, student life and indeed national and international issues that have a bearing on their lives and success.

INDIVIDUAL LECTURER'S FORUMS

- ❑ These are forums with restricted access: only students taught by a particular lecturer may access their forum.
- ❑ For example, only Engineering students can participate in ForumSEET DISCUSSION FORUM (DR FOLA-ADEBAYO)
- ❑ Here, lecturers will start discussions to which you must respond.
- ❑ You may also ask questions from teachers and students, and respond to issues raised by lecturers and other students.
- ❑ Interactions here are graded and form part of your Continuous Assessment.

TELEGRAM AND WHATSAPP

- ✘ Some teachers may also create study groups on social media platforms such as Telegram and WhatsApp.
- ✘ You will receive more information on this from your lecturers.
- ✘ Note however that these are also classrooms and you must comport yourselves accordingly
- ✘ The slides following give rules for the use of online learning platforms

1. MEMBERSHIP AND ADMINISTRATION

- ⌘ All students have to, as part of the course requirements, subscribe to online discussion forums.
- ⌘ You will be pre-registered to participate on the learning site. However, you will need to confirm that registration by logging on, changing your password and updating your profile.
- ⌘ For Telegram and WhatsApp platforms, individual teachers will set parameters on who may add members.

2. LANGUAGE USE AND NETIQUETTE

- ☒ The only language allowed is English, not mother tongue or pidgin.
- ☒ Use language correctly and formally, as in a classroom.
- ☒ Social media contractions, like h8 for "hate" and 4 for "for" and similar abbreviations are unacceptable. No emoticons, emojis and stickers.
- ☒ Treat everyone on the platform with courtesy.
- ☒ All quotes and references to others' ideas and works **MUST** be duly acknowledged by reference to sources.

3. MESSAGE THREADS

- ❏ If responding to a particular message, use the **REPLY** function.
- ❏ If asking a general question, start with **QUESTION**, IN UPPER CASE. E.g.,
 - ❏ **QUESTION: Under what module is "evaluation of online resources?"**
- ❏ If you require the assistance of the teachers, direct the question as follows: **FOR THE ATTENTION OF THE LECTURER.**
- ❏ Don't forget to research before asking.
- ❏ Backread previous posts.

4. *FOCUS: GNS101 EXCLUSIVELY*

- ⓧ No other courses may be discussed.
- ⓧ No religious, racial, ethnic, gender or partisan political issues. No current affairs.
- ⓧ No greetings, good wishes or shout outs.
- ⓧ No adverts of data or political aspirations
- ⓧ Do not re-post or forward messages on this platform.
- ⓧ No acknowledgement unless you are specifically requested to. No "Thank you", "Noted" or "Seen".

PENALTIES

- ❑ Note again that online platforms are extensions of our classrooms.
- ❑ Online behaviour should be as close as possible to behaviour in face to face interactions in classrooms.
- ❑ There will be consequences for misusing the online forums
 - ❑ You may be de-registered and be unable to further participate in online classrooms.
 - ❑ You may lose marks for being a digital illiterate or not being able to use social media for study purposes.